Kayvan Zahiri

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AWS and GCP-certified AI Engineer with production experience in voice AI, ML pipelines, LLM fine-tuning and evaluation, and full-stack development, with 101 PRs merged into OpenAI, Google, NVIDIA, Microsoft and Meta repos.

Open Source

- 101 PRs merged into third-party production repos, including OpenAI's Whisper, Google's SentencePiece, NVIDIA's NeMo and DALI, Microsoft's ONNX Script (5), Meta's FAISS, Hugging Face Transformers and IBM's Docling.
- Whisper and SentencePiece contributions each merged by one of the project's original authors.

Publications

N. Graef, **K. Zahiri**, A. Wasielewski. *Slim attention: cut your context memory in half without loss – K-cache is all you need for MHA*. arXiv preprint, 2026.

Experience

Software Engineer **Remote**
Clipboard Sports *October 2026 - Present*
- Full-stack engineering for a sports technology startup, working directly with the founder and engineering team on the initial development roadmap across frontend, backend, and product.
- Own debugging, testing, and launch-readiness work on core product features.

Teaching Assistant **San Francisco, CA**
University of San Francisco *July 2026 - Present*
- Supported two graduate Data Science (MSDS) courses, with a third upcoming.

AI Engineer **Remote**
Asurion *January 2026 - June 2026*
- Built a voice turn detection system, improving auto-labeling accuracy from 50% to 88%+ (90%+ on a 400 sample validation set).
- Designed and scaled an automated labeling pipeline to auto-label 400k+ audio samples, enabling large-scale fine-tuning of a Whisper-based PyTorch model.
- Deployed the model in a real-time voice AI pipeline (LiveKit), enabling end-to-end conversational agent testing with low-latency inference.

AI Engineer **Remote**
Spotly Jobs *October 2025 - January 2026*
- Engineered ATS data pipelines using dlt and dbt, expanding job posting coverage by 5%+ and scaling automated processing to 500+ postings per pipeline run.
- Built 7 Dagster assets and sensors to automate ETL workflows, cutting manual engineering intervention by 50%+ and saving 10+ engineer-hours per week.
- Improved data ingestion throughput by 30–40% through optimized scraping logic and REST API handling, processing 150–200 additional postings per hour at no added infrastructure cost.

AI Engineer **Remote**
Outlier AI (Scale AI) *May 2024 - September 2025*
- Trained LLMs using Reinforcement Learning from Human Feedback, improving instruction-following accuracy by 20%.
- Evaluated 1M+ tokens across 5+ datasets, identifying 300+ instruction-following errors that directly informed targeted finetuning.

Software Developer **San Francisco, CA**
University of San Francisco *September 2024 - May 2025*
- Lead developer on IDEA team software development, delivering 3 full-cycle applications.

Software Developer **San Francisco, CA**
Founders Network *August 2024 - December 2024*
- Built Slack site integrations into an existing codebase of over 10,000 lines of code.

Software Developer **San Francisco, CA**
University of San Francisco *May 2024 - August 2024*
- Lead developer on a full-stack PeopleMuseum project app (React JS) with a 5,000+ line codebase and sub-2-second load times.
- Created and deployed 2 generative AI Thunkable apps, one of which is featured on PeopleCode.ai's front page.

Projects

Founder of BuildGist

- macOS AI code-explanation app for Claude Code, Cursor, and Codex runs, built on the Claude CLI and then Anthropic's API (Haiku 4.5, Sonnet 5), with severity-rated issue detection, cross-agent handoffs, and Stripe subscriptions: https://buildgist.com/
- Built an evaluation harness measuring factual accuracy, hallucinations, and planted-bug detection; benchmarked model quality, latency, and inference cost to drive model selection and gate server-backed releases on eval results.
- Verified with 2,491 application tests and 53 Rust tests passing at the latest checkpoint.

Founder of ResumeAI

- AI-Powered ATS Resume Optimizer (Next.js, TypeScript, React, Supabase/Postgres, Anthropic Claude API, Stripe, Chrome Extension): https://withresumeai.com/
- Founded and built (solo) a full-stack AI resume platform with ATS compatibility scoring, Claude-powered bullet rewriting, AI cover letter generation, PDF/DOCX export, and a companion Chrome extension; reached active users across 7+ countries with 80%+ week-over-week new-user growth.

ParkCast SF: End-to-End MLOps System for Parking Occupancy Prediction

- Shipped a production parking-occupancy API (FastAPI, Docker, GCP Cloud Run) serving predictions for 12.7K SF blocks at 8.98 MAE / 0.73 R^2 from a 33-feature LightGBM residual model.
- Built a fully automated MLOps retraining pipeline in GitHub Actions (DataSF ingestion, MLflow tracking, and a champion-challenger gate rescored on a shared test set) to block silent regressions before GCS upload and Cloud Run rollout.
- Engineered leakage-safe temporal features (lag windows, recency-weighted training, KNN-inferred block aggregates) to extend metered-only data to citywide coverage and improve event-hour accuracy.

Creator of PantrIQ

- Full-stack AI mobile app (React Native, TypeScript, TailwindCSS, Supabase, Google/Apple Auth, OpenAI) with scan, voice, and text input, AI recipe suggestions, meal planning, shopping lists, and pantry tracking.

Creator of the PeopleCodeOpenAI Python library

- Python library for easy access to OpenAI's tools (text-to-speech, voice recognition, RAG), used in intro courses at the University of San Francisco: https://www.peoplecode.ai/

Technical Skills

Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, Google Cloud Digital Leader
Languages: Python (PySpark, SparkSQL, PyTorch, Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-Learn, Matplotlib, Plotly), TypeScript, JavaScript, Java, C, SQL, NoSQL
AI/ML: Generative AI, Large Language Models (LLM), LLM fine-tuning, RLHF, LLM Evaluation, Prompt Engineering, RAG, Voice AI, Regression, Classification, Unsupervised Learning, Deep Learning
Web/Mobile: Next.js, React, React Native/Expo, FastAPI, Supabase/Postgres, SQLite, REST APIs, Stripe
Tools: Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Git, GitHub, Bash, Docker, ETL Pipelines, Distributed Computing, AWS, GCP, MongoDB, Apache Airflow, Dagster, dbt, MLflow, LiveKit

Education

University of San Francisco — **San Francisco, CA**
M.S. in Data Science and Artificial Intelligence — *July 2025 - June 2026*

University of San Francisco — **San Francisco, CA**
B.S. in Computer Science — *August 2021 - May 2025*